several instances of violations of law, are rarely if ever appropriate for federal-court adjudication.

> "Carried to its logical end, [respondents'] approach would have the federal courts as virtually continuing monitors of the wisdom and soundness of Executive action; such a role is appropriate for the Congress acting through its committees and the 'power of the purse'; it is not the role of the judiciary, absent actual present or immediately threatened injury resulting from unlawful governmental action." *Laird* v. *Tatum*, 408 U. S., at 15.

See also *Gilligan* v. *Morgan*, 413 U. S. 1, 14 (1973) (BLACKMUN, J., concurring).

The same concern for the proper role of the federal courts is reflected in cases like *O'Shea* v. *Littleton*, 414 U. S. 488 (1974), *Rizzo* v. *Goode*, 423 U. S. 362 (1976), and *Los Angeles* v. *Lyons*, 461 U. S. 95 (1983). In all three cases plaintiffs sought injunctive relief directed at certain systemwide law enforcement practices.[25] The Court held in each case that, absent an allegation of a specific threat of being subject to the challenged practices, plaintiffs had no standing to ask for an injunction. Animating this Court's holdings was the principle that "[a] federal court . . . is not the proper forum to press" general complaints about the way in which government goes about its business. *Id.*, at 112.

Case-or-controversy considerations, the Court observed in *O'Shea* v. *Littleton*, *supra*, at 499, "obviously shade into those determining whether the complaint states a sound basis for equitable relief." The latter set of considerations should therefore inform our judgment about whether respondents

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[25] In *O'Shea* v. *Littleton* and *Rizzo* v. *Goode*, the plaintiffs sought wide-ranging reform of local law enforcement systems. In *Los Angeles* v. *Lyons*, by contrast, the plaintiff sought cessation of a particular police practice. The Court concluded in *Lyons*, however, that this difference did not distinguish the cases for standing purposes as long as the plaintiff could show no realistic threat of being subject to the challenged practice.